INNOVATR IRL

Simplicity Has Status

Why South Africans are choosing fewer choices, clearer products and cleaner experiences — and flaunting simplicity like luxury.

Simplicity Has Become a Flex

In a noisy, complicated world, the simplest brands feel the most powerful.

South Africans are tired.
Too many options. Too many tabs. Too many decisions. Too many steps.

Simplicity now signals **confidence**. A brand that is clear, minimal and easy to understand feels more clever — not less.

Complexity looks insecure.
Simplicity looks premium.

Overchoice Is Exhausting. Simplicity Is the Cure.

The country is overwhelmed — reduction feels like relief.

We're living through:

- endless plans, bundles, tiers
- busy packaging
- overstuffed menus
- overwhelming apps
- too many subscription choices
- too much admin everywhere

Consumers don't want more.
They want **less** — but better.

Simplicity reduces anxiety.
Anxiety reduction is status.

South Africans Are Done With "Too Much" 🚫

If it's complicated, it's deleted.

71% ⚡

say "too many choices is stressful"

63%

prefer products with fewer features but clearer value

57% ⚡

abandon online processes when things "feel like admin"

52%

trust brands that "keep things simple"

44%

describe cluttered packaging as "overwhelming"

29%

say fewer decisions = feeling more in control

Chaos is out. Clarity is in.

Minimalism Isn't a Trend — It's Emotional Relief

Consumers reward brands that remove mental load.

People no longer associate more features with more value.

They associate more features with **more effort**.

Simplicity creates:

- quicker decisions
- higher trust
- clearer expectations
- lower frustration
- stronger emotional connection

The new status symbol isn't abundance. It's absence.

Where Simplicity Is Winning Big

Less is **outperforming** more across categories.

Retail

Clean layouts, edited collections, curated "just enough" choices. **Fewer SKUs = higher conversion.**

Telecoms

One-price, transparent plans. Consumers reject bundles that require maths.

Banking

One account. One fee. One interface. **Clarity is the ultimate sales pitch.**

FMCG

Short ingredient lists. Simple claims. Packaging that feels honest and calm.

"I Want Options" vs "I Don't Want to Think This Hard"

Choice is good — until it's too much.

Desire

"Give me choices."

South Africans love variety and freedom of selection

Relief

"But please... not too many."

Too many options create decision fatigue and anxiety

Brands that **curate** simplify without restricting choice — the best of both worlds.

What Simplicity Looks Like in Practice

Clarity, calm and confidence — delivered by design.

- **Reduce choices**
  fewer plans, fewer versions.
- **Use plain labels**
  simple names, simple claims.
- **Declutter interfaces**
  give every screen one job.
- **Clarify benefits**
  don't make people guess.
- **Shorten the journey**
  fewer steps, faster gratification.

Simplicity Converts Faster, Costs Less and Feels More Premium

Making things easy is the most underrated growth strategy.

When brands simplify, consumers:

- convert quicker
- complain less
- trust more
- switch less
- spend more
- return more often

Simple brands win because simple brands respect time.
Respect = revenue.

Simplicity Is a Design Strategy, Not a Trend

And Innovatr tests what clarity feels like — not just what it looks like.

We measure:

- clarity of communication
- simplicity of structure
- packaging calmness
- emotional response to clean design
- decision speed
- friction points
- cognitive load moments

> Simplicity builds trust.
> Trust builds status.

Is Your Idea Simple Enough? South Africans Will Tell You in 24 Hours.

Simplicity is instantly felt — and instantly measurable.

Use Test24 Basic to test:

- clarity signals
- friction moments
- complexity vs simplicity
- packaging readability
- choice overload
- two simplified versions head-to-head

*"If it feels complicated, it will **underperform**."*

*"Simplicity boosts conversion — **instantly**."*

"Consumers choose calm."

R5,000 per idea

Sample size	100 consumers
Turnaround time	24 hours
Process	Upload and go
Deliverable	Simplicity score report

Upload your idea

Your simplicity score lands tomorrow.